



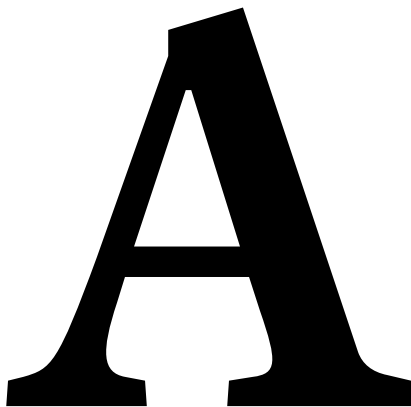
SOWING THE SEEDS

Arun Alagappan increased the breadth of offerings and strengthened the agri-solutions platform to make Coromandel an integrated player

BY **KRISHNA GOPALAN**

PHOTO BY **BANDEEP SINGH**

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RUN ALAGAPPAN'S PASSION for agriculture comes through clearly in how he breaks down each issue succinctly. After all, the Executive Chairman of Coromandel International is as close to the farmer as anyone in India Inc can get; offerings include fertilisers, specialty nutrients, crop protection, retail presence and a play in technology.

Sitting in his spacious but austere room in Coromandel's Chennai office, Alagappan underlines his constant endeavour: making Coromandel a "very cost-effective player." After all, the company plies its trade in a sector that is tightly regulated, has thin margins and requires deep reservoirs of patience; obsession with efficiency is the only way to ensure strong returns.

Farm Champion—Agriculture and Allied

ARUN ALAGAPPAN

EXECUTIVE CHAIRMAN, COROMANDEL INTERNATIONAL

Gross Sales	FY25	24,085
	9MFY26	25,476
Operating Profit	FY25	2,987
	9MFY26	3,012
Profit After Tax	FY25	2,055
	9MFY26	1,784
	FY25 RoE (%)	20.07
	Market Cap	57,236

● Figures in ₹ crore; Financials are on consolidated basis; 9MFY26: April-December 2025 ● M cap as on March 24, 2026 ● Source: ACE Equity

For Alagappan—who moved into Coromandel in early 2021 after stints at other Murugappa group companies like Cholamandalam Investment, TI Cycles of India and Parryware Roca—the pivot to agriculture meant he had to get back to basics.